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We humans now live *healthier, longer lives* than ever before. It is science, and the study of our world around us, which has made this possible.

Although our planet is well over four billion years old, our species, *Homo sapiens*, has only existed for a relatively short time. In less than 100,000 years we have *developed the tools* that allow us to ask—and sometimes answer—the big scientific questions. And now we can not only study life, but even start to *create small primitive organisms* in our laboratories.

Perhaps the biggest question is “What is life?” It sounds so simple, and yet we still cannot fully answer it. Nor do we know exactly when, how, and where life started or *all the complex questions* about how we, and other creatures, evolved. And of course, we do not know whether there are *forms of life* in other parts of the Universe; perhaps it exists on *some remote planet* that we may never see.

This book explores some of these remarkable questions and *celebrates what we know about our life* and the living creatures and organisms that surround us. It is an *amazing story* and I hope by reading this book you will be as excited about the *study of life*—the science we call *biology*—as I am.

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Robert Winston.

ROBERT WINSTON

